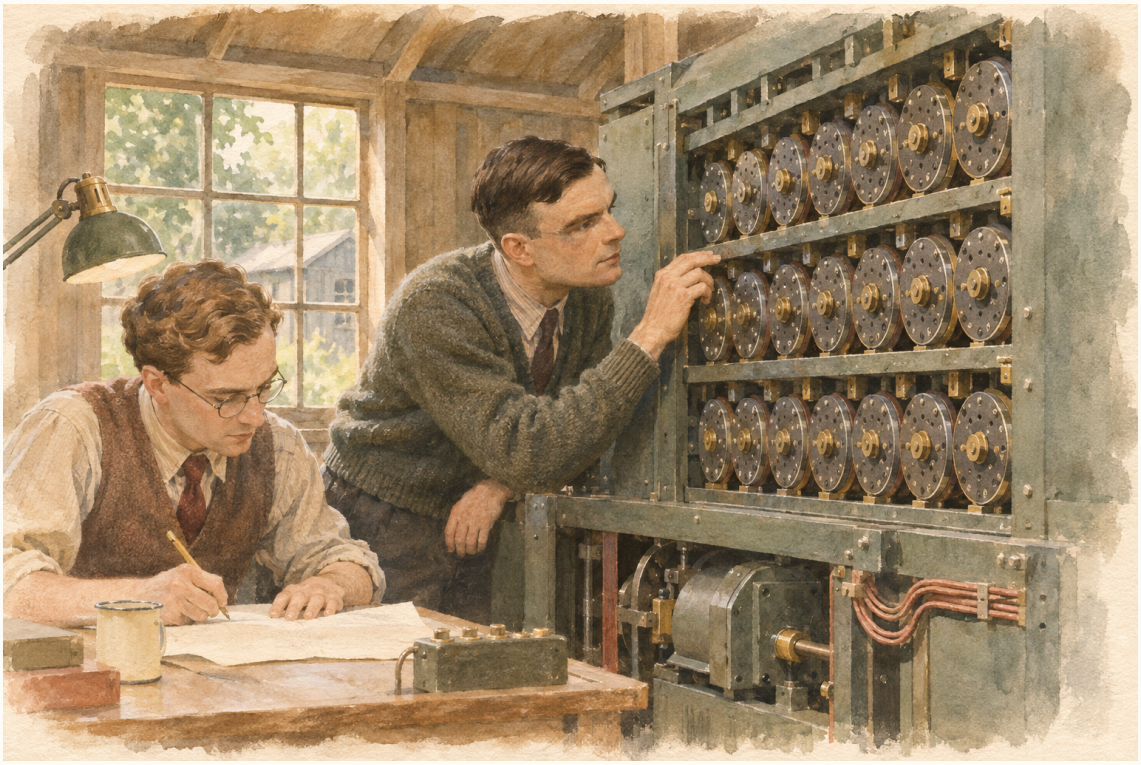
为机器点燃思想的人

The Man Who Gave Machines a Mind



图灵的贡献，为何没能保护他?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Born in June 1912, Alan Turing had a formidable intellect by his early twenties. In a paper read in November 1936, he outlined a "universal machine": a device able to execute any computation, given the right instructions. That abstract construct, rooted in mathematical logic, became the theoretical blueprint of the modern computer.

On 4 September 1939 he joined the classified codebreaking effort at Bletchley Park, leading work on naval Enigma, Germany's encryption machine. Polish mathematicians had deciphered Enigma by late 1932 and shared their insights with Britain and France in July 1939. His team's machines exploited them and, operational from March 1940, automated the laborious search for each day's rotor settings.

In October 1950, writing in the philosophy journal Mind, he posed a provocative question: "Can machines think?" He proposed a practical substitute, the imitation game, now widely called the Turing test. An interrogator exchanges typed messages with two concealed players, one human and one machine. If the interrogator cannot consistently distinguish them, the machine passes.

His exceptional wartime contribution did not protect him. On 31 March 1952 he was convicted of "gross indecency", the charge then used against gay men. He forfeited his security clearance and, to avert imprisonment, submitted to hormone injections. He died of cyanide poisoning on 7 June 1954. A coroner's inquest ruled it suicide, though some doubt it.

Recognition lagged. On 10 September 2009 Britain's prime minister publicly apologised, and on 24 December 2013 Turing was posthumously granted a royal pardon. On 23 June 2021, his birthday, a fifty-pound note bearing his portrait entered circulation. The country that prosecuted him put his face on its money.

中文译文

艾伦·图灵生于1912年6月，二十出头便展现出非凡才智。1936年11月宣读的一篇论文中，他提出“通用机器”的轮廓：只要给出正确指令，这种装置就能执行任何计算。这一植根于数理逻辑的抽象构想，后来成为现代计算机的理论蓝图。

1939年9月4日，图灵加入布莱切利园的机密破译工作，领导针对德国海军恩尼格玛加密机的研究。波兰数学家早在1932年底就已破译恩尼格玛，并于1939年7月向英国和法国分享了思路。图灵团队的机器借鉴这些成果，从1940年3月投入运行，将每天搜寻转子设置的繁重工作自动化。

1950年10月，图灵在哲学期刊《心灵》上提出一个发人深思的问题：“机器能思考吗？”他建议用一种实际可行的替代办法来讨论这个问题，即“模仿游戏”，如今通常称为图灵测试。提问者通过打字与两名隐藏的参与者交流，一方是人，另一方是机器。如果提问者无法稳定地区分二者，机器就算通过测试。

卓越的战时贡献并未保护图灵。1952年3月31日，他因“严重猥亵”罪被定罪，这是当时用来惩治男同性恋者的罪名。他失去接触机密资料的资格，并为避免入狱而接受激素注射。1954年6月7日，他死于氰化物中毒。验尸官的死因调查裁定为自杀，但有人对此存疑。

认可来得很迟。2009年9月10日，英国首相公开道歉；2013年12月24日，图灵获得身后皇家赦免。2021年6月23日，他生日当天，印有他肖像的50英镑纸币开始流通。曾经起诉他的国家，将他的面容印在了自己的货币上。

图灵测试是行为区分标准，不能直接等同于机器具有意识的证明。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

intellect n.
才智；智力
a formidable intellect

execute v.
执行（指令或任务）
able to execute any computation

computation n.
计算
able to execute any computation

abstract adj.
抽象的
That abstract construct

construct n.
理论构想；概念模型
That abstract construct

blueprint n.
蓝图；设计基础
the theoretical blueprint

classified adj.
机密的；保密的
the classified codebreaking effort

encryption n.
加密
Germany's encryption machine

decipher v.
破译；解读
had deciphered Enigma

insight n.
深刻见解；关键思路
shared their insights

operational adj.
投入运行的
operational from March 1940

automate v.
使自动化
automated the laborious search

laborious adj.
费力耗时的
automated the laborious search

provocative adj.
发人深思的；引起争议的
a provocative question

substitute n.
替代办法；替代物
a practical substitute

consistently adv.
稳定地；始终如一地
cannot consistently distinguish them

distinguish v.
区分；辨别
cannot consistently distinguish them

be convicted of 动词短语
被判犯有……罪
he was convicted of

forfeit v.
丧失；被剥夺
He forfeited his security clearance

avert v.
避免；防止
to avert imprisonment

posthumously adv.
在死后；身后地
posthumously granted

pardon n.
赦免
a royal pardon

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

formidable adj.
非凡的；强大的

outline v.
概述；勾勒

device n.
装置；设备

be rooted in 动词短语
根源于；植根于

mathematical adj.
数学的

logic n.
逻辑

theoretical adj.
理论的

codebreaking effort 名词短语
密码破译工作

naval adj.
海军的

exploit v.
利用；运用

rotor n.
转子

philosophy n.
哲学

pose v.
提出（问题）

propose v.
提议；建议

practical adj.
切实可行的

widely adv.
广泛地；普遍地

interrogator n.
提问者；询问者

concealed adj.
隐藏的

exceptional adj.
杰出的；非凡的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

wartime adj.
战时的

contribution n.
贡献

security clearance 名词短语
涉密资格；接触机密的许可

imprisonment n.
监禁；入狱

submit to 动词短语
接受；屈从于

hormone n.
激素

injection n.
注射

cyanide poisoning 名词短语
氰化物中毒

coroner n.
验尸官

suicide n.
自杀

recognition n.
认可；承认

lag v.
滞后；迟迟未到

publicly adv.
公开地

apologise v.
道歉

be aux.
构成过去时被动语态

grant v.
授予；给予

portrait n.
肖像

circulation n.
（货币等的）流通

prosecute v.
起诉；提起公诉

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 That abstract construct, rooted in mathematical logic, became the theoretical _____ of the modern computer.

02 His team's machines exploited them and, operational from March 1940, automated the _____ search for each day's rotor settings.

03 If the interrogator cannot consistently _____ them, the machine passes.

04 Turing was _____ granted a royal pardon.

文章主线

- 理论 1936年，图灵提出按指令执行各种计算的通用机器模型，为现代计算机奠定理论基础。
- 破译 图灵团队借鉴波兰的破译成果，1940年用机器自动搜索德国海军密码机每天的设置，加速破译。
- 测试 1950年，他提出模仿游戏：通过打字交谈，提问者若不能稳定分清人和机器，机器就通过测试。
- 迫害 1952年图灵因同性恋行为获罪，被取消涉密资格，为免入狱接受激素注射；1954年死于氰化物中毒。
- 追认 其死被判为自杀，但有人质疑。英国2009年道歉、2013年给予身后赦免；2021年肖像登上50镑钞票。

参考答案　1 blueprint 2 laborious 3 distinguish 4 posthumously